heard them out and then responded as per their needs. After due examination, I put up the files to my boss, but then I realized that nothing would come back. After a reasonable period of waiting, I went to my senior to ask for a decision on the files I had sent. To my surprise I was advised not to be positive, and that I ought to have learnt my lessons from Delhi traffic and Goa! I felt suffocated! I was facing not only a big wooden table but also a wooden heart. Such a person, I feel, has no moral right to be occupying a position that decided the fate of thousands of men and women posted all over the country, for ensuring the security of the Railways, the passengers and the freight.' She appealed for a change of posting to a senior official in the Prime Minister's Office.

Kiran was now posted as a deputy director in the Directorate General of Industrial Contingency (DGIC) under the Department of Industrial Development. This department was expected to closely monitor industrial relations and send out intelligence and analysis reports. Its head office was located at Delhi, with zonal offices in Delhi, Bangalore and Patna.

This assignment at the DGIC was on an all-India basis and gave Kiran a wide jurisdiction. Her bosses in Delhi were Brijinder Sahay and Bob Murari, both senior IAS (Indian Administrative Service) officers in the Department of Industrial Development.

Kiran found working with them, and in this non-police department, refreshingly different. She added to her daily newspaper reading *The Economic Times* in order to pick up the relevant industrial news and also to stay up to date with the latest developments and to target priorities. She reorganized her office to meet the requirements of her assignment.

She next set about correcting the basics of the DGIC functioning. Alongside, she began travelling to the various industrial units to see for herself the ground realities. On the basis of her findings, she produced certain reports for circulation, some of which were trend-setting in nature. The main objective was to bring about coordination both at the state and Central levels, according to the demands of the situation, so as to effectively respond to industrial unrest or breakdown.

Kiran's reports presented a brief, crisp and precise analysis and the relevant suggestions for tackling specific problems. They just could not be ignored. The DGIC was now making its presence felt, and those organizations that did not come out in a good light started questioning the legitimacy of the DGIC's jurisdiction. Such questioning was firmly and effectively replied to by Brijinder Sahay (Kiran's boss). This step strengthened DGIC work even further.

All reports of the DGIC, such as the special report and the intelligence bulletin, were being sent to the concerned decision makers and needed due coordination. The objective behind this exercise was to achieve a collective focus on the problems without loss of time. Kiran made it a point to ensure that all important reports reached the prime minister (Rajiv Gandhi) directly. In the left-hand corner of each report, she used to write in her own hand (usually on single page reports) 'Mr Prime Minister'.

Kiran learned a lot about the 'ins and outs' of management through first-hand observation. It came as pleasant surprise to her when she got a call from her DG, Brijinder Sahay, that she should fly out to Bokajan (Assam) to try and resolve the strike at the cement plant there. She eagerly accepted this opportunity. Kiran, along with S. Manoharan, the district deputy commissioner, went to the unit and succeeded in signing an agreement within 24 hours, ensuring that the workers' demands were satisfactorily met and they returned to work.

Some of the major units covered by the DGIC included Bokaro Steel Plant, Bharat Leather Corporation, Cochin Refineries and IDPL (Indian Drugs and Pharmaceuticals Limited) (Gurgaon).

It is interesting to learn that the DGIC, after Kiran left in October 1985, was wound up as part of an economy drive by the Government of India. Certainly, some degree of saving had been achieved, but,